Board 1
West Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q 7 3 ♥ A 4 ♦ Q 9 6 2 ♣ A 8 4	
♠ J 10 9 6 4 ♥ 9 8 3 2 ♦ — ♣ Q 10 6 3	N W E S	♠ 8 ♥ K Q 10 7 5 ♦ 10 8 4 ♣ J 9 5 2
	♠ A 5 2 ♥ J 6 ♦ A K J 7 5 3 ♣ K 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

7NT by North
Lead: ♥K

North is to play 7NT. East leads the ♥K, dummy plays the ♥6 and West the ♥2.

With 12 obvious tricks your first thought should be that perhaps the ♠s will split 3-3.

Then, your second thought should be that dummy's ♥J is a Threat against East's ♥Q, so if it is East who holds 4 ♠s you will be able to squeeze him.

Since the contract is 7NT you take the first trick with the ♥A.

With one trick in the bag you should test ♦s next. When you play the ♦A West discards a ♠.

You continue with the ♦Q and ♦ K, West discarding a ♥ and a ♣.

Since West has shown up with a ♦ void he has become the odds-on favorite to hold the ♠ Guard. His ♠ discard makes it very likely that he started with 5 ♠s.

To find out for sure you play ♠A, then ♠Q. Sure enough East discards a ♥ on the second round.

You can't squeeze East in ♥s and ♠s because he doesn't hold the ♠ Guard, West does.

But now a completely new possibility shows up. Say to yourself, over and over, "East must guard ♥s, and West must guard ♠s. Nobody can guard ♣s."

You start playing dummy's ♦ winners.

With one more ♦ in dummy, things look like this.

West discards the ♣6.

When you play the ♦5 West must keep both ♠s to guard against your ♠7. So he discards the ♣6, hoping partner can stop that suit.

Your ♠7 is now worthless so you throw it.

East has no problem, (yet), he discards the ♥10.

It is now time to pressure East.

Play dummy's ♠5 to your ♠K.

East MUST keep his ♥Q so he releases his ♣5.

And you win the last three tricks with ♣K, ♣A, ♣8.

This is called a Double Squeeze.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 5 2
♥ 6
♦ A J 9 7 4
♣ Q 8 4 3

♠ Q J 10 8 3
♥ J 10 7 2
♦ 6 3
♣ 10 6

♠ 6
♥ Q 9 8 4 3
♦ 8 5 2
♣ J 9 7 5

♠ A K 7 4
♥ A K 5
♦ K Q 10
♣ A K 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	3♦	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

7NT by South
Lead: ♠Q

South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♠Q.

One more winner is needed. Dummy's fourth ♣ is a possibility.

So take the ♠K and play ♣ A K Q.

West discards a ♠ on the third ♣.

Now you know East guards the ♣s.

Before tackling ♦s, see what you can discover about ♠s.

Play the ♠A. East discards a ♥.

East guards the ♣s. West guards the ♠s. Nobody can guard the ♥s.

Play 4 rounds of ♦s.

On the fourth ♦ East had to discard a ♥. You discarded a small ♠. West discarded a ♠ on the third ♦ and a ♥ on the fourth.

East discards a ♥.

You play dummy's ♦4. East cannot throw the ♣J or he will set up dummy's ♣8, so he discards a ♥.

You discard the ♠7.

Now West is squeezed. He cannot discard the ♠J or he will set up dummy's ♠9, so he discards a ♥.

You win the last three ♥ tricks with another Double Squeeze.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 5 ♥ A K J 9 8 3 ♦ A 5 ♣ K 8 6 3	
♠ Q 6 2 ♥ 7 5 2 ♦ J 9 8 4 3 ♣ J 4	N W E S	♠ A K J 9 4 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 10 7 2 ♣ Q 10 2
	♠ 10 8 7 3 ♥ Q 10 ♦ K Q 6 ♣ A 9 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	1♠	2♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by North
Lead: ♠A

from your hand.

Then lead dummy's ♣7 to your ♣K.

Here you are in your hand.

Only East can guard dummy's ♠10, and only East can guard dummy's♣9.

East discards the ♣10, holding on to the ♠J.

You play your ♥A and East must give up one of his guards. If he holds on to the ♠J then you toss dummy's useless ♠10. If he throws the ♠J then you toss dummy's ♣9.

North is to play 6♥. East leads the ♠A, then ♠K.

When you looked at just your and dummy's cards on the previous page it may have looked impossible to find a twelfth winner.

Even looking at all four hands here it is still very difficult to come up with a plan.

Here's a hint: If East holds 3 ♣s, (and you see that he does), can you squeeze him in ♣s and ♠s?

Of course you ruffed the ♠K.

The big problem with trying to squeeze East in the black suits right now is that West actually holds a ♠ guard. But you can fix that.

You draw two rounds of trumps with dummy's ♥Q and ♥10.

West plays the ♠Q and you ruff. Then you pull the last trump.

Now play the ♦A, ♦K, and ♦Q, discarding the ♣3

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q 10 ♥ K Q 5 3 ♦ A 8 6 3 ♣ 8 5 2	
♠ A K 9 3 2 ♥ 10 4 2 ♦ J 9 ♣ J 6 4	N W E S	♠ 8 6 5 ♥ J 9 8 6 ♦ Q 10 4 ♣ Q 10 9
	♠ J 7 4 ♥ A 7 ♦ K 7 5 2 ♣ A K 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♠3

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠3. East plays the ♠5.

From the opening lead of ♠3 and East's play of ♠5 you should have deduced that West held five ♠s to the A K. Therefore if you lose a trick in any other suit West will be able to take 4 ♠ tricks and defeat you.

You have 8 winners, and if East holds 4+ ♥s AND 3+ ♦s then only he can guard the two suits.

But how can you squeeze him?

Dummy's ♠10 won the first trick.

The answer to that question is that **YOU** cannot squeeze him.

But maybe you can make his partner do the job for you.

At trick 2 you play a ♠.

Of course West will win this with his ♠K.

And he will no doubt continue with the ♠A and ♠9.

West continues with the ♠A and the ♠9; dummy discards two ♦s.

You discard 2 ♦s from dummy and a ♣ from your hand.

East cannot spare either a ♥ or a ♦ so he also throws a ♣.

Remember this position

West will almost surely cash his ♠2.

West cashes the ♠2; dummy discards a ♣ and East the ♣Q.

You and dummy both discard a ♣ and East also must discard a ♣.

It doesn't matter what West plays next, lets say it is a ♣.

You are in your hand with the ♣K.

You play the ♣A.

East is truly squeezed. If he discards a ♥, dummy's ♥5 will become a winner. but if he discards a ♦ then you will get a third ♦ trick and the contract.

Since it was West who started the squeeze by cashing his last ♠, this is called a Suicide Squeeze.**BUT**, what if West had not cashed that ♠?

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A ♥ A 6 3 ♦ K 5 ♣ A K Q J 9 8 7	
♠ 10 7 5 4 2 ♥ J 10 2 ♦ Q 10 4 3 ♣ 4	N W E S	♠ K Q 9 6 3 ♥ Q 9 8 5 ♦ 9 ♣ 10 6 2
	♠ J 8 ♥ K 7 4 ♦ A J 8 7 6 2 ♣ 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	3♦
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	6♦[4]
Pass	7♣		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace
3. asks for kings
4. 1 king

7♣ by North
Lead: ♠K

North is to play 7♣. East leads the ♠K.

At first glance this doesn't appear to be a difficult hand. You expect to win the opening lead, pull trumps, then establish a ♦ winner by playing ♦K, ♦A, and ruffing a ♦. As long as they split 3-2 you could reach dummy's ♦ winner with the ♥K.

So you take the ♠A, pull three rounds of trumps and play ♦K.

But when you lead to the ♦A East discards a small ♠.

Time to rethink. You are in dummy now, and you can ruff a ♦, return with the ♥K and ruff another ♦. The last ♦ would be good but you'd have no way to reach it.

Think squeeze instead.

You ruff a ♦. This turns the ♦J into a Threat card against West's ♦Q.

But, the ♠J is already a Threat card against East's ♠Q.

You play your ♣J.

Play your ♣J and ♣9, discarding the ♦8 and the ♥4 from dummy.

East can afford to discard the ♠9 and the ♥5.

West can spare his two ♠s.

You are there.

East gives up the ♥8.

Your ♣8 does it.

East cannot throw the ♠Q, so he gives up the ♥8. Dummy's ♠J is of no further value so you dump it.

West cannot throw the ♦Q, so he gives up the ♥2.

And you take the last three tricks with the ♥ suit. There were only two defenders; one of them had to guard ♠s and the other had to guard ♦s. There was nobody left to guard ♥s.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 4
♥ J 9 7 3
♦ K 7 5
♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ A K J 8 6 5 3 2
♥ 8 6 2
♦ 10
♣ 7

♠ 10 9 7
♥ 4
♦ Q J 9 4 2
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ —
♥ A K Q 10 5
♦ A 8 6 3
♣ A K Q 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
4♠	Pass	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠A

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠A.

If ♦s and ♣s split nicely this would be an easy slam. But with that wild ♠ bid by West you can't expect decent splits.

So you ruff the ♠, pull trumps in three rounds, then play ♣ A K and get the bad news when West discards a ♠.

You now know that East guards the ♣s. And since West had 3 ♥s and a very long ♠ suit it is pretty likely that East guards the ♦s also. You will try to squeeze East in ♣s and ♦s, but first you must lose a trick to rectify the count.

West plays the ♦10.

So you play a low ♦ from each hand.

It doesn't matter which defender takes the ♦, since either one is going to do the same thing. Assume West wins the ♦10.

He will then play the ♠K, which you must ruff in your hand.

West discards.

A small ♦ to dummy's ♦K.

You are in dummy, ready for the squeeze.

You play dummy's ♥J.

East gets to choose his own fate - discarding a protector in one of the two suits. Of course, whichever suit he discards you will throw the opposite one.

Yet another slam, courtesy of the Squeeze Play!